

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's talk about parties!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What's the best birthday party you've ever had?
- What was the worst party you've ever been to?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships, character traits and strange events.
- I can express degrees of uncertainty about past events.
- I can express the cause and effect of an action or an event.

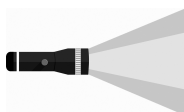




Let's Explore!

Peter, Vanessa and Amy have some friends who **failed to make an appearance***.

* To "fail to make an appearance" means did not show up.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** How much should we play for?
Vanessa: How about for the money you already owe me?
Peter: Heh heh. Amy I forgot to ask, you invited a few of your friends to come out tonight, right?
Amy: Yeah, Jane, who works in my office, wasn't feeling well yesterday. She must have caught a cold, so she didn't want to come out and my other friend Terri didn't answer the phone when I called her. She must have fallen asleep.
Vanessa: I talked to Jose about coming out, but he might have forgotten.
Peter: He can't have forgotten. I sent him a text earlier tonight and he said he would make an appearance.
Vanessa: Maybe he decided to stay at home because the weather is dreadful.
Peter: Good. I hope everyone stays home because the snow doesn't look like it's letting up.
Vanessa: Peter, do you remember Sally's birthday party when no one showed up?
Peter: Sadly.
Amy: Oh no! What happened?
Vanessa: Sally had a birthday party planned at a restaurant on Saturday because she thought people wouldn't come to a party on that Sunday which was her actual birthday.
Peter: She made up a big list of people, sent out invitations to everyone and booked a restaurant. It was going to be a gala evening.
Vanessa: Ohhh! But nobody came Saturday because she had mixed up the dates on the invitations.
Amy: Ohhh! Poor girl! As she was sitting there, wondering where her friends were, she must have felt pretty dejected.
Peter: She said initially, she was feeling pretty irate since no one had come to her party that she worked so hard on to plan.
Amy: What did she do?
Vanessa: She started phoning people and she quickly figured out the mistake. We were able to rebook the next day at nearly the same time, so it all worked out.
Amy: Alright I'm ready. Let's play some ... oh no!
Vanessa: The power is out!
Peter: Yep, it's a blackout!





Let's Practice!

Peter, Vanessa and Amy talk about their friendships and strange turn of events.

Instructions: Underline the incorrect words in the sentences. Write the correct words on the lines.

1. You invites a few of your friends to come out tonight, right?

2. Yep, it's a blackin!

3. She started phoning people and she quickly figure out the mistake.

4. Peter, do you remember Sally's birthday party when no one showed down?

5. He said he is going to take a rainnote.

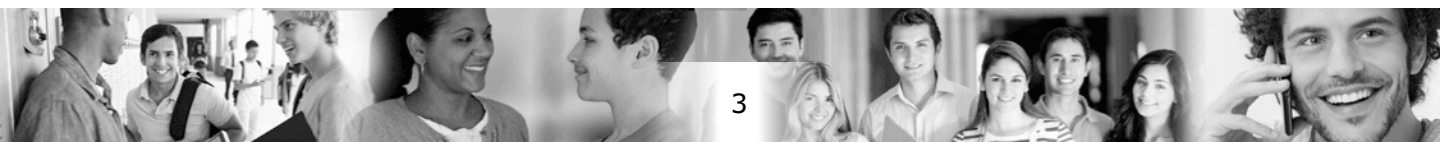


Let's Practice!

Vanessa, Peter and Amy are uncertain about certain events.

Instructions: Choose the structure in each sentence that expresses uncertainty about a past event.

1. She must have caught a cold, so she didn't want to come out.
2. She may have fallen asleep.
3. She must have felt pretty dejected.
4. I talked to Jose about coming out but he might have forgotten.
5. He can't have forgotten.





Extension Activity

Write a story about a terrible party.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a narrative about the worst party experience you've ever had.
- The story can be a true account or a fictional one.
- Explain why it was a terrible experience using **because**.
- Record yourself telling your story on your phone and post it to the Internet.
- Share it with your classmates and ask for feedback.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a story about a terrible party experience.

☐
☐

I explain why it was terrible using because.

☐
☐

I record myself telling the story. I post it on the Internet. I share it with my partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **gala** (noun): a special public occasion at which there is entertainment
e.g. It was going to be a gala evening.
- **to make an appearance** (expression): to attend an event briefly, typically out of courtesy
e.g. I sent him a text earlier tonight and he said he would make an appearance.
- **to take a rain check** (expression): to politely refuse an offer, with the implication that one may accept it at a later date
e.g. He said he is going to take a rain check.
- **to let up** (verb): to become less intense or severe
e.g. I hope everyone stays home because the snow doesn't look like it's letting up.
- **dejected** (adjective): unhappy, disappointed, or lacking hope
e.g. As she was sitting there, wondering where her friends were, she must have felt pretty dejected.
- **irate** (adjective): very angry
e.g. She said initially, she was feeling pretty irate.
- **blackout** (noun): a failure of electrical power supply
e.g. Yep, it's a blackout!





Learning Points

Degrees of Uncertainty when Talking About the Past

All modal perfect verbs refer to the past. You can use them to express different degrees of uncertainty.

Take a look at the chart for a summary of what modal perfect verbs you can use and what they mean:

Modal Perfect Phrase	Meaning/Use	Example
must have done	you are almost sure that something happened in the past	<i>Matt didn't answer the phone when I called him. He must have fallen asleep.</i>
can't have done	you are almost sure that something did not happen in the past	<i>They can't have gone to bed late. They were very tired.</i>
may / might / could have done	it is possible that something happened in the past but you aren't sure	<i>Laura hasn't arrived yet. She may/might/could have missed the train.</i>

Examples:

- *She must have caught a cold, so she didn't want to come out and my other friend Terri didn't answer the phone when I called her.*
- *She must have fallen asleep.*
- *She must have felt pretty dejected.*
- *He can't have forgotten.*
- *I talked to Jose about coming out, but he might have forgotten.*





Learning Points

Cause and Effect: Because + Clause

When you want to talk about cause and effect, there are different ways to go about it. You can use a conjunction like **because** to express the reason or cause of the effect (result).

You can place the cause-clause (because + clause) before or after the effect-clause.

For example:

*The children were happy **because** they received presents.*

***Because** they received presents, the children were happy.*

Notice that you use a comma when the cause-clause comes before the effect-clause.

Examples:

- *I hope everyone stays home **because** the snow doesn't look like it's letting up.*
- *Maybe he decided to stay at home **because** the weather is dreadful.*
- *Sally had a birthday party planned at a restaurant on a Saturday **because** she thought people wouldn't come to a party on that Sunday.*
- ***Because** it was raining, they decided to stay home.*
- *But nobody came Saturday **because** she had mixed up the dates on the invitations.*

